

Akbari Gate (Masjidi Gate)

اکبری دروازہ

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Emperor Akbar
- Built in: Late 16th century, during Akbar's reign
- Cost: Not documented in available sources
- Built for: The original main eastern gate of the fort, used by Akbar himself before the Alamgiri Gate later became the principal entrance

2. Construction Details

- Materials: Masonry gateway typical of Akbar-era fort construction (burnt brick with sandstone elements)
- Technique: Positioned as the fort's primary access point on the city side, aligned with the old Masjidi/Akbari Mandi area outside
- Artisans/craftsmen involved: Not documented by name in available sources
- Time taken: Not documented

3. Historical Background

- Served as the fort's principal gate during Akbar's reign and remained in use through the Jahangir and early Shah Jahan periods before the grander Alamgiri Gate was built by Aurangzeb in the 1670s and took over as the main ceremonial entrance.
- Conservation work at the gate uncovered three superimposed historic floor levels beneath its threshold - a Mughal-period pebble floor (pebbles were favoured because they held up well under heavy elephant and cart traffic), a Sikh-era burnt-brick floor, and a British-period small-brick floor - discovered during restoration work culminating around 2007.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The gate's three-layer flooring is one of the clearest physical, walkable records anywhere in the fort of continuous reuse across the Mughal, Sikh and British periods.
- Pebble paving was specifically chosen by Mughal builders here because it withstood the wear of royal elephant traffic better than flat brick.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Imagine a conservation worker in 2007, carefully lifting a British-era brick from beneath the Akbari Gate, only to find another floor underneath it, and then another - like peeling back the pages of a diary written by three different empires, each one certain their floor was the last word.